

SAVANNA SENTINEL



Deployment Requirements

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Deployment

Savanna Sentinel runs on a single AWS EC2 instance, with the full stack under Docker Compose. This covers how it's deployed, what's needed to stand up a new instance, how the CD pipeline works, and how to roll back.

Environments

Environment	Where it runs	URL
Development	Local machine, <code>docker compose up</code>	<code>http://localhost:5173</code>
Production	AWS EC2, <code>docker compose --profile prod up</code>	see README

No separate staging environment exists. Pull requests with required CI checks (`backend-ci.yml`, `frontend-ci.yml`) are the gate before anything reaches `main`, and only `main` auto-deploys.

Infrastructure

- One EC2 instance (Ubuntu 24.04, t3.small) with an Elastic IP.
- Services: `db` (Postgres+PostGIS), `redis`, `minio`, `backend`, `frontend`, `caddy`.
- `caddy` is the only service exposed on ports 80/443 - everything else stays on the internal Compose network.
- TLS comes from Let's Encrypt via Caddy, for whatever hostnames `SITE_ADDRESS` and `MEDIA_SITE_ADDRESS` are set to. The domain is ``savannasentinel.co.za`` (``www`` included) plus ``media.savannasentinel.co.za`` for serving report/tip-off photos out of MinIO, with `A` records at the registrar pointing all three at the instance's Elastic IP - Caddy requests and renews certificates for them automatically on container start.

First-time setup

1.AWS

- Create an EC2 key pair (download the `.pem`).
- Create a security group allowing inbound `22`, `80`, `443`.

2.Launch

Ubuntu Server 24.04 LTS, `t3.small`, 30GB gp3 storage, using the key pair and security group above. Allocate an Elastic IP and associate it with the instance.

3.Point DNS at the instance

At the domain registrar, create:

- A record: `@` -> `<elastic-ip>`
- CNAME record: `www` -> `<elastic-ip>`
- A record: `media` -> `<elastic-ip>`

Give it time to propagate before continuing, Caddy's certificate request in step 6 will fail if the domain doesn't resolve to this instance yet. Check with:

```
dig +short savannasentinel.co.za
```

It should return only the Elastic IP, nothing else.

4.Install Docker

```
ssh -i your-key.pem ubuntu@<elastic-ip>
curl -fsSL https://get.docker.com | sudo sh
sudo usermod -aG docker $USER
# log out and back in for the group change to apply
```

5.Clone and Configure

```
git clone https://github.com/COS301-SE-2026/Savanna-Sentinel.git
cd Savanna-Sentinel
```

Generate a JWT Secret:

```
openssl rand -hex 32
```

Root `.env` from `.env.example`:

```
cp .env.example .env
nano .env
```

```
POSTGRES_USER=sentinel
POSTGRES_PASSWORD=<strong password>
POSTGRES_DB=savanna_sentinel
MINIO_ROOT_USER=sentinel_minio
MINIO_ROOT_PASSWORD=<strong password>
SITE_ADDRESS=savannasentinel.co.za www.savannasentinel.co.za
MEDIA_SITE_ADDRESS=media.savannasentinel.co.za
```

backend/ `.env` from backend/ `.env.example`:

```
cp backend/.env.example backend/.env
nano backend/.env
```

```
DATABASE_URL=postgresql+asyncpg://sentinel:<same  
POSTGRES_PASSWORD>@db/savanna_sentinel  
JWT_SECRET=<paste the openssl output>  
JWT_ALGORITHM=HS256  
ACCESS_TOKEN_EXPIRE_SECONDS=3600  
REFRESH_TOKEN_EXPIRE_DAYS=7  
REDIS_URL=redis://redis:6379/0  
MINIO_ENDPOINT=minio:9000  
MINIO_PUBLIC_ENDPOINT=media.savannasentinel.co.za  
MINIO_ACCESS_KEY=sentinel_minio  
MINIO_SECRET_KEY=<same MINIO_ROOT_PASSWORD>  
MINIO_BUCKET=savanna-sentinel-media  
MINIO_USE_SSL=true  
MINIO_REGION=us-east-1  
RESEND_API_KEY=<Resend API key>  
RESEND_FROM_ADDRESS=noreply@savannasentinel.co.za  
FRONTEND_BASE_URL=https://savannasentinel.co.za  
MFA_ENABLED=true
```

6.First Launch

```
docker compose -f docker-compose.yml --profile prod up -d --build
```

Verify: `curl https://savannasentinel.co.za/v1/health` should return
`{"status":"ok"}`.

CD Pipeline

`github/workflows/deploy.yml` runs on every push to `main`:

1. SSH into the EC2 instance using repo secrets.
2. `git fetch` and `git checkout` the commit that triggered the deploy.
3. `docker compose -f docker-compose.yml --profile prod up -d --build`.
4. `docker image prune -f`.

Secrets

Set under repo Settings -> Secrets and variables -> Actions:

Secret	Value
EC2_HOST	Elastic IP
EC2_USER	ubuntu
EC2_SSH_KEY	Private key contents (.pem file) for the instance's key pair

Rollback

1. GitHub -> Actions -> "Deploy to production" -> Run workflow.
2. Set `ref` to the commit SHA (or tag) to redeploy.
3. Run it - the server checks out that commit and rebuilds.

This is a plain redeploy-previous-commit.

Changelog

V1

- Initial Version

V2

- Switched live domain from sslip.io to savannasentinel.co.za
- Added DNS setup step, added missing Resend/MFA vars to the backend/.env example

V3

- Added media.savannasentinel.co.za DNS record and Caddy site block.
- Added MEDIA_SITE_ADDRESS to the root .env, MINIO_PUBLIC_ENDPOINT/MINIO_USE_SSL/MINIO_BUCKET/MINIO_REGION to the backend/.env example